

PROSPER AWUNI

IT Cyber Security Specialist | CISSP | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft Defender | Incident Response | Security Architecture

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified IT Cyber Security Specialist with over five years of progressive, hands-on experience in security architecture, incident response, threat monitoring, and vulnerability management within large, complex enterprise environments. I have taken full ownership of cybersecurity controls at the University of the Arts, London, deploying and managing Microsoft Sentinel and the Microsoft Defender suite including Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across an estate of 8,000 users. I work closely with infrastructure operations and technology teams to identify vulnerabilities, respond to security incidents, and continuously strengthen an organisation's overall security posture. I am skilled in cloud security across Microsoft Azure and Entra Identity (formerly Azure Active Directory), and I bring a structured, framework-aligned approach to cyber security using National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, and the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I am seeking a permanent hybrid IT Cyber Security Specialist position where I can contribute to enterprise-grade security architecture and lead a resilient, forward-looking cyber security programme.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL analytics, detection rules, automation playbooks), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent and Insight
- **Threat Monitoring and Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection engineering, alert triage, threat hunting, behavioural analytics
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle (containment, eradication, recovery, post-incident review), playbook development, root cause analysis
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Security Architecture and Infrastructure Security:** Azure/Entra ID, Conditional Access, Public Key Infrastructure (PKI), network segmentation, Zero Trust principles
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Conditional Access, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management (MDM), Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium
- **Email and Perimeter Security:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony firewall
- **Cloud Platforms:** Microsoft Azure, Entra ID, Microsoft 365 (M365)
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, Kusto Query Language (KQL), SOAR automation
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cyber Security Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Take full ownership of cybersecurity controls and security architecture across UAL's enterprise environment, defining standards, implementing security tooling, and providing direction to infrastructure operations teams on embedding security into technology delivery.
- Lead the operational management of Microsoft Sentinel as the organisation's primary Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, developing Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection analytics,

correlation rules, and automated response playbooks aligned to MITRE ATT&CK techniques.

- Manage the full Microsoft Defender suite including Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender across an estate of 8,000 users, providing comprehensive threat visibility, alert triage, and incident response capability.
- Perform proactive threat monitoring and threat hunting across the enterprise, identifying indicators of compromise and anomalous behaviour before they escalate to confirmed security incidents.
- Lead incident response investigations from initial detection through containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review, aligned to the NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle.
- Oversee a structured vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), tracking remediation of critical and high-severity findings across servers, endpoints, and cloud resources.
- Manage Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Single Sign-On (SSO) controls, strengthening identity security for the 8,000-user environment.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege access controls and reduce risk from privileged account compromise.
- Contribute to security architecture reviews and infrastructure projects, ensuring security controls are embedded from design through to implementation in line with NIST, CIS Controls, and ISO 27001 standards.
- Manage Mimecast email security, Check Point Harmony firewall, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM), and Tanium endpoint management platforms.
- Develop and maintain cyber security policies, procedures, and user awareness programmes to promote a security-conscious culture across the institution.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Operated the organisation's SIEM platform, performing daily log ingestion, event correlation, alert triage, and investigation of potential security incidents across the enterprise environment.
- Supported end-to-end incident response activities including initial triage, containment coordination, evidence gathering, and post-incident reporting aligned to established response procedures.
- Conducted scheduled and ad-hoc vulnerability assessments across on-premises and cloud infrastructure, producing remediation reports and tracking fixes through to resolution.
- Managed identity and access management processes including user provisioning, access reviews, group policy management, and enforcement of Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) via Azure Active Directory (Azure AD).
- Developed and refined SIEM detection rules, correlation queries, and alerting thresholds to improve the fidelity and coverage of threat detection across the environment.
- Liaised with infrastructure operations teams to coordinate security patching, hardening activities, and compliance with CIS Controls and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.
- Delivered security awareness training and phishing simulation exercises to reduce risk from social engineering attacks.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered security and infrastructure engineering across the organisation's Software as a Service (SaaS) and FinTech platform, supporting IT security controls and compliance requirements.
- Managed on-premises and cloud infrastructure including server, network, and endpoint systems, implementing security monitoring, access controls, and hardening standards.
- Performed security quality assurance tasks, ensuring adherence to organisational security policies and industry security best practice across development and production environments.
- Supported incident identification, triage, and resolution, collaborating with development and operations teams to address security findings within agreed timescales.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Delivered a Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender deployment across 8,000 users, achieving full endpoint and identity threat visibility across the enterprise.
- Engineered a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel detection engineering programme using Kusto Query Language (KQL), significantly improving alert fidelity and reducing investigation overhead through automated triage playbooks.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege access governance, eliminating uncontrolled privileged account exposure across the technology estate.
- Delivered Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID Conditional Access and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) for 8,000 users, substantially reducing the organisation's identity attack surface.
- Built and operationalised a Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) programme to continuously validate security control effectiveness and prioritise remediation efforts.
- Established and maintained the organisation's Cyber Essentials Plus compliance posture, supporting successful certification and alignment with NIST Cyber Security Framework (CSF) and CIS Controls.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
-

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)